

Chapter 2

In What Sense a Geopolitical Knowledge-Based Economy?



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2.1 Introduction

Over the past three decades, it has become typical to argue that we are living in an era marked by the prominence of knowledge in all societal, economic and cultural developments, as well as pronouncements about the knowledge-intensive form of capitalism as an important subtext for inter-state relations and inter-spatial competition. Inter-spatial competition has become a sort of global attraction game and rivalry: the more notable firms that operate in high-tech in particular or creative industries more generally locate their functions within a given state borders, the more this signals the competitiveness of the state and cities and regions within states (Moisio, 2008). In short, the purportedly ever-intensifying competition between places to host economic activities in the upper parts of the value chain signals that the knowledge-based economy is a domain of social and political action that stretches well beyond the mere economic practices, transactions and commodities that are customarily associated with such economy.

In this chapter, I seek to geopoliticize the purportedly geoeconomic present. In particular, I argue that the contemporary knowledge-intensive capitalism is a historically contingent geopolitical constellation that brings together a range of issues such as space, cities, states, human capital, education, and technology. The paper proceeds as follows. In section two, I discuss the concept of knowledge-based economy. In section three, I make some notes on the concept of knowledge-based economization, which refers to the knowledge-based economy as a set of discursive and material capitalist processes. In section four, I single out some of the geopolitical dimensions of the process of knowledge-based economization. I underline that the

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relational spaces of knowledge-intensive capitalism are constantly re-territorialized in political action that seeks to manage, regulate and fix in place the restless circulation of capital. I conclude the chapter by presenting some thoughts regarding the ways in which knowledge-based economization is a polarizing political-economic process – both spatially and socially.

2.2 On the Concept of the Knowledge-Based Economy

Authors like Chris Freeman (1995) have argued that the idea of “national systems of innovation” – a concept of which came to symbolize the knowledge-based economy in the 1990s – can be traced back to the work of Friedrich List in the nineteenth century. Accordingly, List’s conception of the national system on political economy ([1841] 1991) already highlighted that nations should not only acquire the achievements of other more advanced nations, but should increase them by their own efforts. These would include state-orchestrated technical education, science and training as well as research and development practices; the state should also carry long-term policies for the industry and economy more generally. The growth of government laboratories in the nineteenth century would indicate not only how the method of invention became the greatest innovation of the nineteenth century, but also how the “national” innovation process came to determine the competitiveness of the state more generally (Freeman, 1995, 9).

Over the past four decades, we have been experiencing the rise of new kinds of knowledge-intensive capitalism, labelled as, for instance, soft capitalism (Thrift, 2005), cultural cognitive capitalism (Scott, 2017), the third industrial revolution (Rifkin, 2013), or even surveillance capitalism as a form of rogue capitalism (Zuboff, 2019) or the like. The origins and development of the knowledge-based economy can be examined through historically contingent academic theories and policy ideas. Indeed, different readings of the “knowledge economy” demonstrate that since the Second World War scholars from different disciplines and perspectives have sought to understand and conceptualize certain structurally transformative tendencies in the capitalist economy. They have thus sought to make sense of the shift towards a sort of post-industrial economy that focuses on the production and consumption of knowledge and “symbolic goods” as a higher-order economic activity that ultimately affects and re-works the entire economy and society (Peters, 2010). Thus, Peter Drucker’s (1969) notion of a knowledge worker (already in 1959), including the founding of the entire scholarly field of knowledge management, as well as the sociological work of Daniel Bell (1973) that emphasized the relative importance of theoretical knowledge in post-industrialism, all disclose how changes have been underway on the economy-society interface over the past decades.

Since 1990s, the knowledge-based economy has been particularly associated with issues such as learning, creativity, and entrepreneurship. Many of the concepts that were originally tailored to explain and understand the emergence of such

economy have become central terms that have been tirelessly used by policy-makers within the OECD-world in particular. To illustrate, the World Bank (1991, 33–35) concluded revealing in the early 1990s that it is “intangible investment in knowledge accumulation” which is decisive rather than physical capital investment as was at one time believed. This and other formulations of the time were premised on the work of Paul Romer (1986) and other “new growth theorists” who suggested that innovation, learning, human capital, entrepreneurship and technology are fundamental for “endogenous growth”. Similarly, knowledge and related investment in human capital were in these theories treated as key assets for growth and profits, assets that were not subject to finite restrictions. It may not come as a revelation, therefore, that the strategic political role of universities, for instance, has fundamentally increased during the consolidation of the knowledge-based economy as what Bob Jessop (2005) calls both a hegemonic meta-object of governance or meta-governance that can be understood as responses to the crisis of Atlantic Fordism as a regime of capital accumulation. The power of the knowledge-based economy as a form of meta-governance partly derives from the fact that a number of actors are enrolled behind it. Importantly, as Jessop reminds us, the knowledge-based economy as a successful economic governance also depends on the co-presence of both economic and extra-economic or noneconomic forms: as a set of economic operations, the knowledge-based economy is constituted by the extra-economic systems such as science, education, law, social institutions, traditions, etc (see also Bachmann & Moisiso, 2022) .

In this paper, I use the concept of the knowledge-based economy in particular to refer to the contemporary actually existing economy that highlights knowledge, innovations, learning, higher education, research and development, technology, and entrepreneurialism as crucial components in the creation and extraction of value and in the world of political competition between states, cities and regions.

The materiality of the knowledge-based economy became salient in some of the advanced capitalist states in the latter half of the 1980s. This was the time when the main source of wealth in market economies was gradually switching from natural assets (most notably land and relatively low-skill labor), through tangible created assets (most notably buildings, machinery and equipment), to intangible created assets (Dunning, 2000, 8). In other words, in the knowledge-based economy, the creation and extraction of value is fundamentally based on “knowledge” and “information”, both of which might be embodied in human beings, in organizations, or in different kinds of physical assets.

The knowledge-based economy signals the increasing relative significance of knowledge and innovation in the generation of “national wealth”. In the knowledge-based economy, knowledge creation becomes as an essential source of competitive advantage to many sectors of the economy, with a special emphasis on R&D, higher education and various knowledge-intensive industries ranging from the ICT to various cultural industries and the media (Peters, 2009, 4). According to Sum and Jessop, the knowledge-based economy can be conceptualized as

An actually existing economy whereby the primary aspect of capital is the valorization of the general intellect in the form of knowledge- and design-intensive commodities (real or fictitious). This involves the production, management, distribution and use of knowledge as a key driver of economic growth, wealth generation and job creation across the private, public and ‘third’ sectors. In a true KBE, it is suggested, knowledge is applied reflexively to the production of knowledge and most sectors tend to become more knowledge-intensive. (Sum & Jessop, 2013, 284)

As an actually existing economy, the knowledge-based economy brings together capitalist production, as well as distribution, exchange and consumption of commodities, as well as the extra-economic factors such as education, values, political subjectivity, norms, beliefs, and political institutions. As such, the knowledge-based economy can be understood as a set of economic, societal and political processes.

2.3 On the Concept of Knowledge-Based Economization

Knowledge-based economization can be understood as proceeding through a set of strategic initiatives which include the tempting promise of limitless growth: an antidote to the various material and environmental limits to economic growth under Atlantic Fordism which had become obvious already in the 1980s. In this capacity, the discourses of knowledge-based economization are firmly bound to the ways in which capitalism has been represented since the 1990s as the only societal system capable of providing infinite growth and profit (Moisio, 2018a).

The concept of knowledge-based economization refers to the constant social and political production of the knowledge-based economy as an actually existing economy in all kinds of economic imaginaries, and in economic as well as extra-economic practices. By using the concept of knowledge-based economization, I hence underline that all capitalist accumulation regimes can be understood as instituted processes whereby the state and different extra-economic practices ranging from education and science to law and collective identities play a central role (see Polanyi, 1982). This is one of the reasons why universities (as spaces of science, learning and innovation), for instance, have figured prominently within the imaginaries of the knowledge-based economy during the past three decades.

As the discussion above hints, the concept of knowledge-based economization shifts attention from the narrow understanding of economy towards the processes of economization (see, in particular Çalışkan & Callon, 2009). In these processes, a number of social issues are constantly translated into economic issues and articulated as if they were “pure” economic matters. This kind of economization also happens conversely when economy-related matters are articulated and enacted upon as if they were societal, political and collective “we” issues. This latter aspect has been highly salient in the context of the economic promise that has been associated with the role of higher education in societal development since the 1990s, in particular. In knowledge-based economization, both research and higher education are

articulated and understood as fields of societal action that secure the economic success of political communities and the welfare of their inhabitants.

“Knowledge” has four different meanings in the context of knowledge-based economization (cf. Moio, 2018a). First, it refers to the role of ideas and related innovations in the creation and extraction of economic value. Second, the attempts to commodify knowledge are coupled with knowledge-production by experts, academics, consultant companies, and organization such as the *World Economic Forum* on the knowledge-intensive form of capitalism itself. This knowledge-production indeed plays a crucial constitutive and performative role in knowledge-based economization. Third, knowledge refers to the ceaseless gathering of data on the development and performance of political communities as knowledge-based economies. This data is constantly used in policy-making and territorial governance of political communities. Fourth, knowledge in the context of knowledge-based economization refers to the pervasive datafication of societies. At the age of digitalization, data emerges as a form of valuable pool of information regarding the behavior, needs and desires of human beings. Information thus can be collected, stored, processed, commodified and, finally, realized as profit in money form. The processed data can be utilized in different ways ranging from political surveillance to marketing.

In sum, the concept of knowledge-based economization refers both to the material processes of knowledge-intensive capitalism, and to the processes whereby this form of capitalism is constructed discursively through economizing imageries and related objectifying social practices. These latter practices refer to all kinds of league tables and indices that measure the “competitiveness” of, for instance, universities, cities and states. In so doing indices reify states, cities, regions and universities as “real” units of global competition.

2.4 Geopolitics of Knowledge-Based Economization

Typically, geopolitics refers to the state-orchestrated politics of “hard” territorial force and spheres of influence. More often than not, geopolitics is still understood narrowly to denote drawing state borders, building nations as definite territories, constructing domestic social order through spatial techniques of coercion and consent, controlling territorial spaces through new military technologies within and beyond a given state, as well as geographical and historical justifications of territorial claims. The concept of geopolitics is therefore almost without exception associated with the idea of the purportedly territorially consolidated twentieth-century European state and the wider system of military strategy. This narrow understanding stems from the key political characteristics of the “industrial era” of the nineteenth and twentieth century: command of territory and natural resources were pivotal dimensions of interstate rivalry and fundamental constituents of national wealth and status. The contemporary geopolitical condition is characterized by two processes and related imaginaries. The first is about the abovementioned issues of “hard” territorial power as states vie for power: occupy land areas and control “sea

territories”, for instance. Territory, strategy and associated national identity politics have hence not ceased to be important factors in the contemporary historical context. One possible way to approach such geopolitical territorialization in the context of knowledge-based economization is to examine the ongoing inter-state competition between powerful states over particular “territories of technology” or technological influence. During the past few years, China and the US in particular have treated big tech corporations as if these firms represented national interests of their “host states”. In so doing these states have sought to divide the world into spheres of technological influence (Sellar et al., 2020). The US, for instance, has attempted to restrict companies such as Huawei to operate in different geographical contexts beyond China. These restrictions tailored to contain the purported capacity of the Chinese government to abuse the data that Huawei collects and processes through its digital platforms.

The geopolitics of knowledge-based economization pertains in particular to the ways in which the relational world of contemporary capitalism – flows of money, talent and ideas – is constantly re-territorialized in political action through states, cities and regions. It is for this reason that states, cities and regions have become units of competition in a sort of global attraction game which highlights issues such as connectivity, access to global networks and concentration of particular assets that are valuable in “global competition”. In knowledge-based economization, a key political issue for states, cities and regions is how to manage global mobility, and hence how to bolt these political communities to the global value chains. Not surprisingly, the processes of knowledge-based economization effectively restructures states spatially.

Particular geopolitical imaginaries regarding global competition play a central role in the processes of knowledge-based economization. As Gramsci (1971) succinctly points out, the consolidation of regimes of capital accumulation depends on the exercise of intellectual, political and moral leadership. This leadership is needed in order to translate the new accumulation regime into entire society. In other words, mere technological advances and other narrowly economic issues cannot alone secure the consolidation and maintenance of the knowledge-based economy as a regime of capital accumulation. Jessop (2005) underscores how imaginaries with their constitutive and performative role occupy a key role in this translation process.

The knowledge-based economy as a regime of accumulation is discursively produced in expert knowledge and geopolitical imaginaries regarding global competition and competitiveness. These imaginaries divide the world and states into “zones” in terms of their potential in value creation and extraction in the knowledge-based economy. These imaginaries hence inescapably re-structure the state as an economic territory.

One peculiar geopolitical aspect of knowledge-based economization is that some of its constitutive imaginaries highlight the quintessential role of the nation-state in global competition. Accordingly, national political institutions fundamentally affect the relative rates of technological change and, thus, of economic growth and success of nation-states. This idea was powerfully articulated by Harvard business

management scholar Michael Porter in the early 1990s in his conceptualization of the “competitive advantage of nations”:

Competitive advantage is created and sustained through a highly localised process. Differences in national economic structures, values, cultures, institutions and histories contribute profoundly to competitive success. The role of the home nation seems to be as strong or stronger than ever. While globalisation of competition might appear to make the nation less important, instead it seems to make it more so. With fewer impediments to trade to shelter uncompetitive domestic firms and industries, the home nation takes on growing significance because it is the source of the skills and technology that underpin competitive advantage. (Porter, 1990, 19)

It is important to recognize the discursive power of such a geopolitical imaginary regarding the nature of inter-state competition. It is equally important to recognize the central role of theories and related geopolitical imaginaries which highlight how post-Fordism increases rather than diminishes the role of places and regions in the production process at the age of “flexible specialization”. To illustrate, at around the same time when Porter was formulating his theory on the competitive advantage of nations, notable economic geographers (e.g. Storper & Harrison, 1991; Scott, 1991) highlighted the importance of sub-state “regions” for network developments and economic developments in post-Fordism. Accordingly, local infrastructures, traditions, and externalities, especially in skills and local labour markets, specialised services and not least, mutual trust and relationships between organizations and individuals, contribute significantly to flourishing of “regions” and locales as new economic territories.

Since 1990s, the processes of knowledge-based economization have premised on “hub and flow imaginaries” concerned with the state and world. These highlight the role of particular sites, places and collective subjects in the creation of value, and in the controlling of global flows of money and talent. If a creative entrepreneur (this figure can take many forms) has been an ideal economic subject in knowledge-based economization, clusters, creative cities, start-up cities, smart cities, learning regions, innovation centres, happy cities, innovation ecosystems, to name but a few, have become concrete articulations of the spatial organization of the knowledge-based economy.

The geopolitical location game in knowledge-based economization is of course structured by the essential dynamics of global capitalism. David Harvey’s (1985, reprinted in Harvey, 2001) notes on the geopolitics of capitalism are important in this context. In Harvey’s theory, geopolitics emanates from the internal political-economic dynamism of the capitalist mode of production in general and from the circulation of capital in particular. The capitalist mode of production is always inescapably spatially constituted, and requires certain social (such as education) and physical (such as buildings and laboratories) infrastructures to support the circulation of capital.

The inter-spatial competition in knowledge-based economization takes an urban form, and revolves around the attractiveness of urban social and physical infrastructures in particular. The geopolitical paradox inherent in knowledge-based economization is that nationally and locally anchored spatial formations are needed to

actually facilitate the geographical mobility of capital, but this mobility results only in a chronic instability of existing national and local configurations. This is why the geopolitics of knowledge-based economization emanates from the very tension within the capitalist circulation process in space: the tension within the geography of accumulation between fixity and motion. In the process of knowledge-based economization, states and cities seek to fix in place the restless flows of “knowledge-intensive” capital that searches for optimal locations for the creation and extraction of value. In knowledge-based economization, the tension between the territorial and the capitalist logic of power is a pervasive one: “capitalism perpetually strives, therefore, to create social and physical landscape in its own image and requisite to its own needs at a particular point in time, only just as certainly to undermine, disrupt and even destroy that landscape at a later point in time” (Harvey, 2001, 333).

In order to respond to the needs of the restless flows of capital that embody the knowledge-based economy, the state operates increasingly selectively with regard to its territory (also Jones, 1997). All kinds of urban spaces of innovations are politically construed economic territories that both local and national state authorities hope will serve as territorial platforms or “spatial exceptions” (Ong, 2006) through which both economic and political success can be achieved. The imaginaries that constitute and sustain knowledge-based economization are highly city-centered and growth oriented, and they often present cities as “smart” solutions to economic and political crises.

In political debates in advanced capitalist states, as well in mainstream scholarly work in urban economics and in related fields, as well as in the work of all kinds of consultant companies and guru scholars, issues such as innovation, productivity, internationalization, growth and creativity are increasingly brought together and associated with large cities and their urban fabric (Jonas & Moisio, 2018). As a result, the production of states as territories of wealth has gradually become more urban in nature. The imperative of urbanization hence manifests itself increasingly in the sometimes peculiar alliances between actors who articulate urban economic growth in terms of common national interest (Moisio & Rossi, 2020). One may indeed argue that the transformation of cities towards increasing entrepreneurialization, and the process of producing the state as an entrepreneurial social organization have been important geopolitical aspects of knowledge-based economization (Moisio, 2019). As part of this geopolitical process, large cities, in particular, increasingly embody national competitiveness and attractiveness. Crouch and Le Galès (2012, 406) argue aptly how

...states have shifted resources to invest massively in their capital cities and in urban infrastructures, from information technology to research, financial platforms to transport. Nothing can stop them developing national champion cities or regions, as competition policy is directed solely against favouring firms and industries, though in practice favoured locations are often associated with specific industries, even specific companies, and these can benefit from advantages being given by public policy to the geographical space. Such strategies constitute particularly literal examples of economic patriotism. Patriotism is associated with the defence and promotion of nations, lands, territories; in the strategies being discussed here, economic patriotism takes the form of advancing the interests of specific parts of the national territory.

The geopolitics of knowledge-based economization also refers to particular extra-economic micro-spaces that play a significant role in the production and maintenance of knowledge-intensive capitalism. It is for this reason why universities, for instance, have become fundamental geopolitical sites in knowledge-based economization and in related “global” inter-spatial competition. Harvey (1978, 121) explains how a consolidation of a regime of capital accumulation involves bringing the behaviors of people including economic and political agents “into some kind of configuration that will keep the regime of accumulation functioning”. Knowledge-based economization has been characterized by efforts to generate new “creative” capitalist collective subjects also in the spaces of higher education. The crafting of these geopolitical subjects of knowledge-intensive capitalism in educational practices merits more attention in research. Indeed, we still know relatively little on the ways in which the crafting of these “creative” subjects of knowledge-intensive capitalism in the spaces of higher education brings together the relational-economizing spatial imaginaries and the territorial strategies of states and cities, and also how this crafting of political subjectivity actually re-works the capacities and orientations of these new geopolitical subjects.

The crafting of geopolitical subjects of the knowledge-based economy discloses that knowledge-intensive capitalism not only needs people with certain skills, but it also requires “communicative, cooperative, and affective labor” (Hardt & Negri, 2000: xiii), and thus, particular subjectivities. The concept of the geopolitical subject therefore refers to an organized set of human figures, who are, from the perspective of political power, equipped with particular ideal skills, behaviors, orientations and “spatial mindsets” which can be harnessed in the production of territories of wealth and competition at the age of global competition. As such, a geopolitical analysis of knowledge-based economization seeks to understand the ways in which such economization involves manipulating and guiding bodies and lives spatially in the age of a conceived war over talent (Moisio, 2018a).

2.5 Concluding Remarks

In spatial terms, the process of knowledge-based economization has shifted qualitatively since the early 1990s. It first emerged in the form of late-Keynesian technopolization, and was produced in the strategies of the “entrepreneurial state”. Since the late 1990s, knowledge-based economization has manifested itself in all sorts of imaginaries and practices that are predicated on the idea of “smartness”. After the global recession in 2008, knowledge-based economization has again proceeded through new forms. During the past few years, it has become increasingly salient in the constitutive imaginaries of the so-called start-up economy. In this context, the advanced capitalist societies are witnessing interesting expansion in the processes of entrepreneurialization and urbanization of the nation-state (Moisio, 2018b).

The era of knowledge-intensive capitalism has been marked by remarkable optimism that all kinds of technology-based economic innovations would pave way to

a new brave world. According to the utopian technology-centered narratives in particular, this world would be characterized by enormous economic profits and increasing cooperation and interaction between happy individuals and communities, as well as by a culture of rational reasoning, emancipation and equality, as well as by well-functioning democracy.

It is the role of critical social science to examine and challenge the largely positive image of the knowledge-based economy. As Joe Painter (in Sellar et al., 2020) argues, the knowledge-based economy involves a number of regressive elements ranging from its impact on the environment to gender-related issues. Importantly, some of the highly problematic elements of the knowledge-based economy stem from the state-mediated operations of capital and the related inequality. Indeed, these state-mediated operations evidently entail significant “spatial sortings” that divide places and regions into winners and losers, and are hence very exclusionary.

The processes of knowledge-based economization have the capacity to place certain places and segments of population at the epicenter of development and capital accumulation and at the same time marginalize places and particular segments of the populace. It may not be a terrible exaggeration to argue that some of the spatial contradictions of the knowledge-based economy as a regime of capital accumulation are becoming increasingly evident. In its dominant “progressive neoliberal” form, the process of knowledge-based economization produces tremendous amounts of wealth for some segments of the populace and some places while placing others on the social and geographical margins. To illustrate, one characteristic of knowledge-based economization has been the concurrent rise of all kinds of urban innovation complexes (Zukin, 2020) in major urban centers and the marginalization of lesser urban agglomerations and rural areas. Policies that support the formation of start-up ecosystems and other constituents of innovation complexes effectively produce the strategic urbanization of the nation-state, and concrete manifestations of spatial sortings that characterize the late knowledge-intensive capitalism. It is a commonplace that the growth potentials are today located in the urban hubs of the knowledge-based economy, whereas areas outside the hubs are experiencing relative decline due to “structural change” in the economy. Public and private investments are at the core of this structural process that peripheralizes places in knowledge-intensive capitalism, while it centralizes other localities. At least three important research topics stem from this aspect of knowledge-based economization:

1. Knowledge-intensive capitalism is fundamentally constituted in and through different kinds of spatial sortings. These sortings both include and exclude places and actors in such an economy. A critical examination of spatial sortings is important given that in public policy-making the knowledge-based economy is often represented as the result of a self-propulsive mechanism of endogenous development when compared with the purportedly “dirty” era of manufacturing, resource extraction, and patriarchal Fordist-Keynesian statehood.
2. The central organizing logic of the post-Keynesian world is not the valuing of people as workers and consumers, but the expulsion of people and the destruc-

tion of traditional capitalisms to feed the needs of high finance (Sassen, 2010) and high technology. One of the central organizing logics of the contemporary knowledge-based economization is the spatial sorting of places and people in relation to their purported capacity to contribute to the development of such economy beyond mere consumption and use of technologies invented elsewhere.

3. The state has played a key role in processes that have resulted in the spatial split between “favoured” and “less-favoured” places and regions under knowledge-driven capitalism. Yet, this remains an understudied topic. The extent to which the spatial sortings of late knowledge-intensive capitalism are mediated by the state remains an important empirical question.

Already more than two decades ago, rightwing conservatives James Dale Davidson and William Rees-Mogg (1999) argued that the change from “industrial societies” to “information societies” produces a city-centred and competition-centred world characterized by a deep divide between winners and losers. In their view, the winners would be transnational “cognitive elites”, knowledge workers with high incomes and increasingly trans-local relations and lifestyles. The losers would be people who have difficulties coping with the new transnational world. Indeed, this latter segment of populace has been constantly expanding during the past decade – both within state territories and within major urban agglomerations. It consists of new service class that operates within the digitalized platform economy, the educated precariat whose skills are only in temporary use (at best), and the lower social classes whose welfare gains are under constant threat. Indeed, Dale Davidson and Rees-Mogg (1999) warned that the deepening inequalities between the winners and losers of the information age would end up turning those on the bottom of the pyramid towards highly revanchist nationalist politics. Interestingly, this is exactly what has happened in Europe and elsewhere over the past years.

It is actually a very important geopolitical question whether we are witnessing, as Nancy Fraser (2019) suggests, a gradual evaporation of progressive neoliberalism. Most obviously, this form of neoliberalism has been a major political force behind knowledge-based economization since the 1990s: a force that has manifested itself powerfully as a particular type of “Silicon Valley worldview” that highlights the borderless world. Even though this worldview is certainly not a monolith, it is highly possible that we are currently witnessing the rise of alternative ideological-political formations and associated geopolitical worldviews that challenge the hub and flow imaginaries upon which knowledge-based economization has been premised over the past three decades.

Finally, critical scholars should not only scrutinize the spatial organization of the knowledge-based economy, but also examine the corporeal representations and experiences of knowledge workers working and living within and under the imperatives of such an economic form. This would also require new kinds of analyses on the university as a geopolitical site under knowledge-based economization. The latter would require the use of all kinds of innovative ethnographic and other methods. It is equally important to focus on the everyday statehood, and to analyze the many ways in which state-orchestrated policies and wider regulatory frameworks seek to

control and manipulate citizens and human capital in order to develop particular competitive forms of life within a given state territory (Moisio et al., 2020). These and many others are important topics given that knowledge-based economization keeps mutating and takes new forms in the future.

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